

It doesn't make sense for all of us to walk around pretending like we don't care about money.

The truth is, regardless of how you politically identify, in our capitalist society, money matters. Not for the finer things in life, but for the freedom it provides you. Sure, this book could be about how to overthrow the capitalism system, but we haven't figured that one out just yet.

If you work a job, pay taxes, pay rent or a mortgage, exchange your time for money and exchange your money for basic necessities like water, housing and goods, you are contributing to a thriving economy and (likely) a capitalist society. And if you're helping it grow, it's about time you took your rightful piece of the investing pie, instead of just letting the people up top reap the benefits of your labour. The money you earn from your investments can then be used to redistribute back into the causes you believe in, whether that be generational wealth for your family or the organisations and charities that matter to you most. We should not continue to be exploited and left behind due to a lack of financial education.

Money, most importantly, provides freedom. Too many times growing up I saw the effects of money being used against women. I came from a largely patriarchal background, and the financial imbalance between men and women is the foundation it stands on. I saw how the 'provider' of the family gets to call the shots. They get the final say. Too many times I saw women be asked to quit their jobs and become housewives, only to have their lack of income thrown back in their face during stressful periods.

I've seen women have their opinions not taken seriously because they aren't the breadwinner or don't have an impressive job title. I've seen women train for decades in their skillset, only to be pressured into giving up their careers to raise their children so their husbands could focus on their careers instead.

The patriarchy needs that financial imbalance to work. And the people who benefit from this know: many successful women in arranged marriages can tell you stories about how their education and job titles were used by their in-laws to show off how intelligent their future daughters-in-law were, but after marriage they were coerced by the family to quit working and perform household duties instead.